

receive validation from their relationships." Perhaps because they grow up more sheltered—for over two-thirds of the women, marriage is the first time they stay away from their parents for long. That would explain what women's activist Ranjana Kumari describes as selective modernity: "Women are just not thinking of, or for, themselves. This says a lot about their autonomy. Modernity is not only about wearing daring dresses and going to the disco."

SILKEN CORDS, STEEL SCAFFOLDING

They do want change, but only within the paradigm. So while more women are inclined to marry young (over two-thirds feel the right age to get married is 22-25 years compared to 26-30 years for men), they would also prefer just one child (unlike 62 per cent of the men, who want two, though this trend is set to change, with 16-24-year-olds preferring fewer children). And while being thrifty makes them more hard-headed when it comes to the future, they also have more fun in the present. Women watch more television across time slots; use the Internet more for chatting, less for job hunting; and surprisingly, like comedy movies (63 per cent compared to 56 per cent for men).

If the prospective family divides the men and women, the parental family unites them. Family is as—if not more—

What is the average time youth spend at work?

5-8 hours 9-12 hours 2-4 hours Over 12 hours

55

34

3

2

While the average earning age has declined, men seem to work harder

All figures in per cent; Rest: Don't know/Can't say; Figures don't add up to 100

Which is the favourite spot for meeting your girlfriend/boyfriend?

Parks/
gardens

School/
college/
tuitions

Restaurants Shopping
malls

27

26

16

12

Though 42 per cent have a girlfriend/boyfriend, social spaces are rare

All figures in per cent; Rest: Don't know/Can't say; Figures don't add up to 100



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